

For Counselors: Updates from Tufts University

1 message

Tufts Admissions <undergraduate.admissions@tufts.edu>
To: hakamaneshkarimi@gmail.com

Tue, Sep 22, 2026 at 5:19 PM



New students mark their arrival at Tufts with the annual Illumination Ceremony. Photo credit: Alonso Nichols

Dear Student Champion,

Greetings from Tufts University!

You're busy, we get it. Here's what you need to know:

Application Process: What's New

- We have modified our [Short Answer Prompts](#). This year, applicants are asked to respond to two short answer prompts:
 - *Prompt 1:* Please describe how you have learned about and engaged with Tufts during your college search process (75-150 words)
 - *Prompt 2:* Response to a program-specific question reflecting on a recent class assignment, project, or art portfolio piece (100-200 words)
 - Tufts strongly discourages the use of generative artificial intelligence for writing college admissions essays and short answer responses.
- Alumni Interview
 - Tufts no longer offers alumni interviews to applicants for undergraduate admission.
- First-Year Application Deadlines
 - Tufts adjusts our application deadlines each cycle to ensure they fall on dates when our office is accessible to applicants with last minute questions.

- *Early Decision 1*: November 2, 2026
- *Early Decision 2*: January 4, 2027
- *Regular Decision*: January 4, 2027
- [Supporting materials](#) may arrive after application deadlines.

SAT/ACT Test-Optional Policy

- The [test-optional policy](#) remains in place for the foreseeable future.
 - Generally, Tufts encourages applicants with scores of 1300 or higher on the SAT or 28 or higher on the ACT to include those scores with their application for admission.
 - The majority of applicants last year submitted SAT or ACT scores with their applications.
 - About 75% of admitted students submitted SAT or ACT scores with their applications and 25% of admitted students did not submit SAT or ACT scores.
- Tufts encourages applicants with Advanced Placement (AP) scores of 3, 4, or 5 to report those scores with their application.
 - Tufts does not expect students who attend high schools that do not offer the AP curriculum to take any outside AP courses or sit for AP exams.

Financial Aid

Tufts meets 100% of demonstrated financial need for all admitted students, regardless of citizenship status.

- [Tufts Tuition Pact](#): US undergraduates will attend Tufts tuition-free if their annual family income is under \$150,000 USD per year, with typical assets
- Students whose family income is under \$60,000 per year receive a loan-free financial aid award.
- Three [financial aid estimators](#) are available to support US students seeking greater clarity about how much a Tufts education might cost.

Do you work with emerging artists?

Tufts Admissions is [growing our email list for college counselors, art teachers, and student champions that support emerging artists](#) on their path to fine arts degrees. The School of Museum of Fine Arts at Tufts is a decidedly distinct option for artists to learn, create, and collaborate in an arts community embedded in an R1 research university. We'd love to share information with the professionals guiding artists on their path to studio art programs.

**JOIN SMFA
MAILING LIST**

Thanks for all you do,

JT Duck
Dean of Admissions & Enrollment Management
Tufts University

Tufts is a top research university where bright minds solve problems together. With the opportunities of greater Boston, Tufts students explore across 150 majors and minors, turn curiosity into real-world impact, and gain the skills to achieve their professional goals. Tufts proudly meets 100% of the demonstrated financial need of all admitted students.

